



A Road Less Travelled: Harry Dean Stanton

Pretty in Pink

Pretty in Pink

Director: Howard Deutch
Production Company:
Paramount Pictures Corporation
Executive Producers: John Hughes,
Michael Chinich
Producer: Lauren Shuler
Associate Producer: Jane Vickerilla
Production Associates: Karen Kovacevich,
Elena Spiotta
Unit Production Manager: Arne Schmidt
Location Manager: Charles J. Newirth
Production Assistants: Ronald W. Payne,
Matthew Freeman
Assistant Directors: Stephen Lim, Carol Green
Screenplay: John Hughes
Director of Photography: Tak Fujimoto
Camera Operator: Jack N. Green
Special Effects: John Frazier
Editor: Richard Marks
Associate Editor: Jane Schwartz Jaffe
Production Designer: John W. Corso
Set Designer: Lois M. Mann
Set Decorators: Jennifer Polito, Bruce Weintraub
Production Illustrator: Paul S. Power
Costume Designers: Marilyn Vance,
Donna Roberts Orme
Men's Costume Supervisors: Michael W. Hoffman,
Julene McKinney
Men's Set Costumer: Darryl Athons
Make-up Artist: Tommy Cole
Title Design: Wayne Fitzgerald
Opticals: Pacific Title
Music: Michael Gore
Orchestrations: Leon Pendarvis
Music Supervisor: David Anderle
Supervising Music Editor: Richard Stone,
Segue Music
Music Recording: Joel Moss
Choreography: Kenny Ortega
Sound Recording: Darin Knight
Sound Re-recording: Gary Bourgeois, Mel Metcalfe,
Chris Carpenter
Supervising Sound Effects Editor: Robert Grieve
Sound Effects Editors: Dennis Drummond,
George H. Anderson, Linda Whittlesey
ADR Editor: George Berndt
Stunt Co-ordinator: Dick Hancock
Stunts: Patrick Romano, Erik Cord, John S. Platt
Technical Consultant: Jeanne Weber
Filmic Consultant: Bruce A. Block
Animal Trainer: Gary Gero
Cast:
Molly Ringwald (*Andie Walsh*)
Harry Dean Stanton (*Jack*)
Jon Cryer (*Duckie Dale*)
Annie Potts (*Iona*)
James Spader (*Steff McKee*)
Andrew McCarthy (*Blane McDonough*)
Jim Haynie (*Donnelly*)
Alexa Kenin (*Jena*)
Kate Vernon (*Benny*)
Andrew Dice Clay (*bouncer*)
Emily Longstreth (*Kate*)
Margaret Colin (*English teacher*)
Jamie Anders (*Terrence*)
Gina Gershon (*girl friend, gym class*)
Bader Howar (*salesgirl*)
Christian Jacobs (*boy in record store*)
Audre Johnston (*Benny's mother*)
Melanie Manos (*girl at party*)
Maggie Roswell (*Mrs Dietz*)
Dweezil Zappa (*Simon*)

Producer and writer John Hughes' bittersweet tale, with a soundtrack that includes tracks by The Psychedelic Furs, New Order, Echo & the Bunnymen, INXS, Suzanne Vega and Orchestral Manoeuvres in the Dark, made stars of Andrew McCarthy and Molly Ringwald, and saw Hughes corner the American market in love-struck teens and the ennui of peer pressure. Stanton, in possibly his most mainstream role, is effective and remarkably clean-cut (for once) as the father of Ringwald's teen in love.

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Working on a John Hughes film such as *Pretty in Pink* doesn't necessarily mean you have to seek re-enrolment in high school, but you do immediately find yourself immersed in the pop culture of today's under-21 set. It can't help but jar you on a multitude of levels.

On the film set, you hear the be-bopping music of actress Molly Ringwald's favourite band, the Rave-Ups. Your wardrobe becomes less conservative when Hawaiian silk shirts are the fashion rule for men and women. You start thinking about an after-hours trip to Los Angeles' Hard Rock Cafe... and junk food is suddenly the in nutritional diet. But, most of all, you find yourself listening carefully to the conversations of today's 17-year-olds, comparing it to what you were probably thinking at a similar time in your own life's pathways. It's an ongoing perspective that extends from behind the scenes to the very texture of the film being captured on celluloid.

Texture plays a very important ingredient in *Pretty in Pink*. It's a word that pops up in conversations with actors and crew more than any other, and it extends to every creative department, from costume designer Marilyn Vance and her legions of detailed and designed Zoids and Richies, to the pop set decorations of Jennifer Polito, to the incorporation of music in virtually every key sequence, to the selection of locations in Los Angeles which are simulating the real places of suburban Chicago, even to the grouping of cast still photographic portraits.

All around the film set, everything conforms to the specific vision of John Hughes' most personal screenplay to date.

The idea for *Pretty in Pink* had been germinating in Hughes since his own high school days. Andie Walsh's situation was something he had personally witnessed, a firsthand experience he wanted to write about.

'I think that at one time or another,' he adds, 'everyone has felt a moment of embarrassment or shame and tried to cover up some aspect of his family life or the way he lived. It's a common emotion. *Pretty in Pink* is about pride and how one finds a way to deal with an unpleasant reality.

'Andie is a young girl who doesn't have a great deal of money, and yet she attends a high school for rich kids where most of the students come from wealthy and socially prominent families. There is a lower strata to this primarily affluent community and that is where Andie is from. Among her classmates, she's judged not always for what she is, but for what she has and who her parents are or were.

'I always thought it was tragic that young people could be affected by things over which they have had no control. Andie can't help being born poor, just as

Jimmy Podrasky, Tommy Blatnik, Timothy J. Wilson, Terry Wilson, Bruno, Jeffrey Hollis, Kevin Ricard, David Sutton, Kevin Williams, Rock Deadrick (*Talk Back members*)
Karen Laine (*girl at prom*)
Kristy Swanson (*Duckette*)
Kevin D. Lindsay (*Kevin*)
USA 1986
97 mins
Digital

A Road Less Travelled: Harry Dean Stanton

Cool Hand Luke

Wed 2 Sep 20:30; Sun 27 Sep 14:45

Escape from New York

Fri 4 Sep 20:55; Tue 29 Sep 18:35

Pat Garrett and Billy the Kid

Sat 5 Sep 20:30; Sun 27 Sep 18:00

The Missouri Breaks

Sun 6 Sep 12:10; Wed 16 Sep 20:30

Wise Blood

Mon 7 Sep 20:55; Sat 19 Sep 18:20

Lucky

Fri 11 Sep 18:15; Thu 24 Sep 21:00;

Thu 1 Oct 20:55

Wild at Heart

Sat 12 Sep 18:10; Fri 25 Sep 20:30; Sat 3 Oct 18:00

Repo Man

Sat 12 Sep 20:50; Fri 18 Sep 18:15

Paris, Texas

Mon 14 Sep 18:00; Sat 26 Sep 20:10;

Sun 4 Oct 18:00

The Straight Story

Mon 21 Sep 18:20; Sat 3 Oct 12:20

Pretty in Pink

Fri 2 Oct 18:10; Mon 5 Oct 20:45

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the rich kids can't help being born rich. But she has to come to terms with that and accept what she is.'

Initially, Hughes conceived of the story from a young man's point of view. That, however, changed when he first met Molly Ringwald when they worked together on *Sixteen Candles*.

'I talked with Molly a little bit about the idea which came to be my screenplay for *Pretty in Pink*,' Hughes relates, 'and she was intrigued by it because she could relate to the story.' With his lead thus set in mind, Hughes structured *Pretty in Pink* (the title comes from a song by the Psychedelic Furs) around Molly, an approach similar to the one he took in creating *The Breakfast Club*. And although the characters are different, Hughes admits that *Pretty in Pink* is, in certain ways, a sequel to his earlier film, maintaining its spirit and tone.

Molly Ringwald discovered that the Andie Walsh character she would be portraying hit close to home in many emotional ways. 'We're both very level-headed,' she explained. 'We both know what we want to do and we do it. Andie isn't indecisive about anything. She has a lot of pride and dignity and admires small things others wouldn't even focus upon. She can look at something like a piece of fabric and recognise that she can make something more out of it, which is an important part of her character. I do the same thing.'

'Andie is also very honest,' Molly continues. 'It comes from knowing what she wants. She's not overly ambitious or nasty about it. She just knows that she's not going to get anywhere unless she does it all by herself.'

About the screenplay, Molly admitted, 'Reading a John Hughes script is like having dessert. You get so many bad scripts for films which are offered to you, and it gets boring and monotonous until you begin to lose hope that a good script will turn up at all. When you read one of John's scripts, you really get involved, engrossed and excited.'

'I remember reading *The Breakfast Club* on a plane from New York back to Los Angeles, and I couldn't put it down the entire time until I had finished it. I didn't eat because I was engrossed in reading the script, it was so well done.'

Early in the project *Pretty in Pink*, Hughes decided that directing chores for the film would be handled by someone else other than himself, in this case a film directorial newcomer, Howard Deutch.

Hughes explains his reasons: 'There's a point where I have to start giving some of these stories to other people. If I direct them all myself, I can do maybe one movie every nine months, that is, if I want to shorten my life by several years. But I can write four or five scripts during the same time period, which I've done in the year 1985. If I work with other people like Howie, I can produce more material.'

'I also like being the executive producer,' he admits. 'You don't have to get up as early. And someone like Howie, who is a very talented man, understands the material as if he had written it. Every time I came on the set or looked at the dailies, I would say, "I wish I'd done this one." But I have to get over that and move on to other things.'

Production notes